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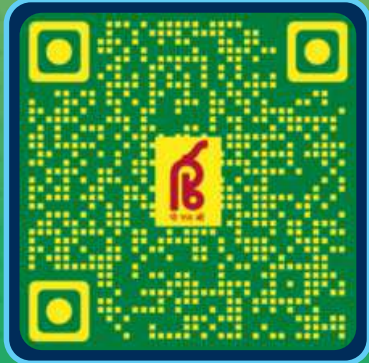
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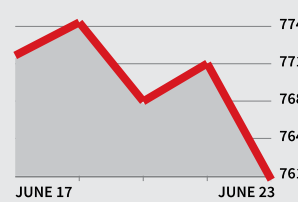
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	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23824.10	-278.80
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.69	-0.24
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.73	+0.06
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	144414.00	-2306
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	227483.00	-10318



WOONG INVESTMENTS.

CII President R Mukundan argues for a stronger focus on domestic resource security and long-term competitiveness **p3**

TAKING STOCK.

Ahead of a likely super El Nino, the Centre has identified 111 districts highly vulnerable to crop damage **p8**

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QUICKLY.

GOVT SUPPORT

Revival hopes rise for Calcutta Stock Exchange



Kolkata: A board meeting of the 118-year-old Calcutta Stock Exchange (CSE) is expected later this month after the West Bengal government proposed supporting its revival. In the State Budget, Finance Minister Swapan Dasgupta said the bourse was on the verge of closure. However, the CSE can resume operations only after receiving SEBI nod. **p6**

EASE OF BIZ PUSH

RBI simplifies TReDS onboarding for MSMEs

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday issued final guidelines for the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS), simplifying the onboarding process for MSME sellers and expanding the role of insurers and credit guarantee fund trusts in supporting transactions on the platform. The move aims to improve ease of doing business for MSMEs and boost their participation on TReDS. **p7**

NSE, SBI Mutual Fund IPOs may yield ₹5,400 cr tax bonanza

WINDFALL FOR GOVT. LTCG tax collections set to jump from the two OFS issues

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The proposed initial public offerings (IPOs) of the National Stock Exchange (NSE) and SBI Mutual Fund are set to deliver a double bonanza — hefty gains for selling shareholders and a sizeable tax windfall for the Centre.

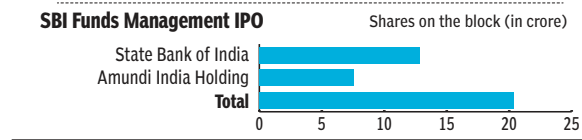
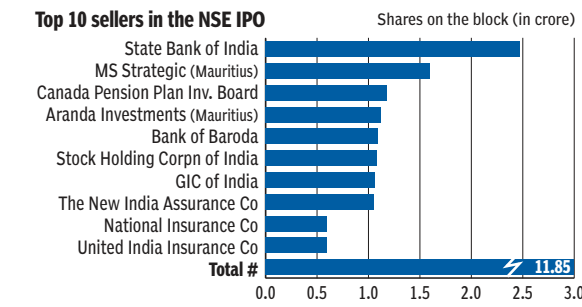
Since both the issues are entirely ‘offers for sale’, the selling shareholders will have to pay long-term capital gain tax at 12.5 per cent, subject to adjustment of the acquisition cost and exemptions available under the law.

A back-of-the-envelope calculation suggests that the ₹30,000 crore NSE IPO could fetch the government ₹3,700-3,800 crore. Similarly, the government is expected to garner about ₹1,500-1,600 crore from the estimated ₹13,000 crore SBI Mutual Fund IPO.

MEGA TAX HAUL

Per Section 112A of the Income Tax Act, long-term capital gains are taxed at a concessional rate of 12.5 per cent on profits exceeding ₹1.25 lakh, without the bene-

Cashing out



Source: Company DRHP filed with SEBI; # Top 10 sellers in NSE IPO account for 79 per cent of total issue

fit of indexation.

Among the prominent shareholders offloading stakes in the NSE IPO are State Bank of India (2.47 crore shares), MS Strategic (Mauritius) (1.60 crore shares), Canada Pension Plan Investment Board (1.19 crore shares) and Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd (1.12 crore shares).

The promoters of SBI Mutual Fund — State Bank of India and Amundi India Holdings — plan to sell 12.83 crore and 7.53 crore equity

shares, respectively, through the IPO. On June 17, the NSE formally filed its Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP) with SEBI for a 100 per cent OFS issue.

Existing shareholders are diluting nearly 6 per cent of their holdings, and the bourse is expected to command a valuation of over ₹5 lakh crore.

TAX TREATMENT

Manoj Purohit, Partner and Leader, Financial Services Tax, Tax & Regulatory Advis-

ory, BDO India, said, “The capital gains tax framework draws a clear distinction between listed and unlisted financial assets, primarily through the lens of holding period.”

In contrast, investors in unlisted shares and certain categories of mutual funds (other than equity-oriented) must hold these assets for at least 24 months for them to qualify as long-term capital asset and become eligible for the concessional tax rate.

While there are no specific exemptions from capital gains tax, corporate investors and shareholders largely rely on offsetting losses where available.

The top 10 shareholders participating in the NSE OFS are expected to pocket gains of about \$2.6 billion (₹24,600 crore), based on acquisition prices disclosed in the draft prospectus.

SBI alone is estimated to realise gains of around ₹4,700 crore, while MS Strategic (Mauritius) could make approximately ₹2,934 crore, per *Reuters* calculations based on prospectus disclosures and valuation estimates.

Trade talks begin amid farmers’ concerns over India opening agriculture market to the US

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer and Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday began two days of talks to advance negotiations on an interim trade deal, amid concerns from some farmer groups over Washington’s demands, which they fear could undermine India’s agricultural interests.

“The US remains focussed on securing a fair, reciprocal trade deal that opens markets for American exporters and delivers benefits to both nations,” the US Embassy to India posted on social media platform X, reinforcing Washington’s long-standing push for lower tariffs and greater market access for American goods, including agricultural products, in India.

While Goyal has maintained that India’s sensitive farm sectors are being fully protected in the negotiations, farmer groups remain apprehensive as the bilateral trade framework announced in February identified agriculture as a key area for deeper market access. Their concerns have been reinforced by repeated references from US officials to securing greater access for American farm products in the Indian market, raising fears that any tariff concession could adversely affect domestic producers.

“The India-US joint statement of February 7 states that India will eliminate or reduce tariffs on US industrial goods and a wide range of agricultural products, in-



PACT PROGRESS. US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal in New Delhi on Tuesday us EMBASSY IN INDIA X

cluding DDGs, red sorghum, tree nuts, fruits, soybean oil, wine, and spirits... Allowing imports of heavily subsidised US agricultural products will destroy domestic production in affected sectors,” KV Biju, National Coordinator, Rashtriya Kisan Mahasangh, said in a letter this week to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, also marked to Goyal.

The letter was sponsored by over 40 farmers’ and fishers’ organisation from across the country.

IMPLICIT TAXATION

The biggest concern is US agricultural subsidies, the letter noted. “The US Farm Bill allocated \$956 billion in 2014 and \$1.5 trillion in 2024. According to the OECD (2024), the Producer Support Estimate (PSE) is +7.1 per cent in the United States, while Indian farmers face a negative PSE of -14.5 per cent, effectively amounting to implicit taxation,” it said.

In a separate letter to the PM, the Tamil Nadu Farmers Protection Association re-

minded him of his “repeated assurance” that in the India US trade negotiations the interests of India’s farmers, fishermen, and those involved in dairy and poultry would be fully protected.

“The India US joint statement issued on February 6 about the interim agreement does not provide us much hope that the interests of India’s farmers would be fully protected. We urge you to stand by your promise and not buckle under US pressure to sign the interim agreement which compromises India’s agriculture,” it said.

ENTRY TO GM MAIZE

India seems to have agreed to addressing long-standing barriers to US exports of agriculture and food products, pointed out the Bhartiya Kisan Union in its petition to Modi.

“This could facilitate imports of highly subsidised dairy and poultry products, and also provide a backdoor entry to genetically modified maize into India,” it said.

Infosys bets on \$400-billion AI opportunity by 2030

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Artificial intelligence will not replace IT services companies but will instead create a \$300-400 billion AI-first services market by 2030, according to Infosys Chairman Nandan Nilekani.

Addressing shareholder concerns over the impact of AI on the IT services industry during the company’s 45th annual general meeting (AGM) on Tuesday, the Infosys Co-founder said the sector was undergoing one of its biggest technology transitions. “The industry is going through a major technology transition, during which questions are asked about our relevance, leadership or ability to maintain growth and margins. Given that AI is a much larger and more disruptive technology transition than ever before, the

questions are louder and the doubts more insistent. The existential question is: If coding becomes automated, why are we needed at all?” he said.

AI TO AMPLIFY

More than three years after the advent of generative AI, Infosys remains more relevant than ever and is well-positioned for the decade ahead, Nilekani said.

While the company will adopt advanced coding tools to improve productivity, substantial work remains across the broader software development lifecycle.

“The AI deployment gap in our large enterprise clients is real, and closing that gap is where the work is. AI will not replace companies like ours, but amplify those who move with purpose and adapt with speed,” he said.

Nilekani said the AI revolution had made legacy



Nandan Nilekani, Chairman, Infosys

modernisation urgent, with clients increasingly seeking to retire decades of accumulated technical debt.

“The preference will increasingly be to build rather than buy software. All this creates larger opportunities for us. The defining opportunity lies in integrating intelligent AI systems with mission-critical enterprise platforms. The greatest value will come from combining the world of models

and agents with traditional transaction systems that continue to underpin enterprise operations. That convergence is where the next wave of opportunities will emerge,” he added.

ROBUST PERFORMANCE

Despite a challenging macroeconomic environment, Infosys reported revenue of \$20.2 billion in FY26, up 3.1 per cent in constant currency terms. The company maintained an adjusted operating margin of 21 per cent and generated \$3.7 billion in free cash flows, equivalent to 112.6 per cent of the net profit. Large deal total contract value (TCV) stood at \$14.9 billion, with 55 per cent classified as net new.

Infosys CEO and MD Salil Parekh said the company ended the year with 41 clients generating annual revenue of more than \$100 million each. “One critical area

we have focused on over the past year has been taking our AI approach to the market. We have built platforms such as Topaz and Fabric, which enable us to deliver strong AI capabilities to clients in partnership with leading AI companies,” Parekh said.

He outlined six broad areas where clients are deploying AI to drive growth, improve service quality and enhance efficiency. These include AI engineering and strategy, data, process transformation, technology modernisation through AI agents, physical AI across sectors such as manufacturing, healthcare and automotive, and AI trust focused on security and responsible AI.

“When we look at this collectively, we see an addressable market of about \$300 billion over the next five years. It gives us a clear focus on how we drive growth,” Parekh said.

Sparks fly as TN CM Vijay and LoP Udhayanidhi clash

TVK chief’s blistering attack on DMK in the Assembly has the DMK leader responding on X

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Sparks flew on Tuesday as Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Vijay and Opposition leader Udhayanidhi Stalin had a heated exchange. This was one of the sharpest confrontations between the two since the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) assumed office.

The fireworks began when Vijay launched a blistering attack on the opposition Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) during his 45-minute reply to the debate on the Governor’s Address. The speech culminated in Vijay mimicking a gesture made by predecessor MK Stalin, triggering strong reactions from DMK members.

The gesture quickly went viral on social media, with users even sharing a collage



TAKING A DIG. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay mimics DMK leader MK Stalin’s gesture as he concludes his reply to the debate on the Governor’s address **ANI**

comparing Stalin’s gesture in March, when he finalised a seat-sharing agreement with the Congress ahead of the Assembly elections, and Vijay’s imitation.

FIERCE WORDS

During his speech, Vijay accused the DMK of collecting funds from party cadres and supporters without adequately accounting for how the money was spent.

To drive home the point, he narrated an anecdote about a man who repeatedly sought money from people but never fulfilled his promises, a story widely interpreted as satire on the DMK’s fund-raising practices.

He slammed his critics for calling the TVK an actor’s party, stating his government represented the interests of the people.

He took swipes at the DMK leadership through anecdotes. One story about a “missing man” was seen as a veiled reference to former Chief Minister MK Stalin (who lost in the elections), with his son Udhayanidhi purportedly searching for him in the Assembly.

As he concluded his speech, Vijay sought the Speaker’s permission to enact a gesture he intended to perform in the presence of DMK members.

“I wanted to enact this gesture in the presence of the DMK members. However, all of them have walked out. Can I do it with your permission?” he said.

UDHAYANIDHI RESPONDS

After receiving approval, Vijay mimicked Stalin’s hand gesture and took his seat, drawing laughter from

the ruling party benches.

Udhayanidhi hit back shortly afterwards on social media platform X, accusing the Chief Minister of filling his speech with “baseless allegations” and “punch dialogues” instead of addressing key governance issues. There were no answers regarding power outages, farmers’ issues, the deteriorating law and order situation, or plans to fulfil election promises, he said.

The gloves were clearly off when earlier Udhayanidhi said the entire State was well aware of the story regarding the wife searching for her husband at the Chengalpattu court.

The personal exchange between the Chief Minister and the Opposition leader at the start of the new government is not a healthy sign, said a political expert.

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QUICKLY.

Honasa Consumer to buy 58% in Fluence Pharma



New Delhi: Honasa Consumer said it will acquire 58 per cent stake in Fluence Pharma, a science-backed nutraceuticals company, via secondary purchase at about ₹135 crore enterprise value, subject to closing adjustments and completion of conditions precedent. It will acquire the rest through secondary purchase in two tranches over the next five-seven years from completion of acquisition. **OUR BUREAU**

VinFast India signs MoU with Shriram Finance

Chennai: VinFast India, the Indian subsidiary of global EV manufacturer VinFast, has signed an MoU with Shriram Finance, a leading retail NBFC, to enhance consumers' access to financing solutions and support the wider adoption of electric mobility in the country. Through this partnership, prospective VinFast customers will benefit from Shriram Finance's tailored financing solutions, including up to 100 per cent on-road funding, attractive interest rates and flexible repayment options across VinFast's product portfolio. **OUR BUREAU**

BIS certification for Ola Electric's LFP 46100 cell



Bengaluru: Ola Electric Mobility has announced that its wholly-owned subsidiary, Ola Cell Technologies, has secured Bureau of Indian Standards certification for its indigenously-developed LFP 46100 cylindrical cell. The cell has qualified under international and domestic safety protocols. This validation follows comprehensive electrical, environmental and mechanical endurance tests ranging from thermal abuse to impact and vibration testing. **OUR BUREAU**

Retailers recorded 5% growth in May amid inflationary pressures

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Retailers recorded 5 per cent year-on-year sales growth in May and this was sequentially lower than April due to inflationary pressures, as per the monthly business survey released by the Retailers Association of India (RAI). This growth was led by essentials and quick service restaurants (QSR) segments. The industry body noted that the consumers remained cautious and value-conscious during the month. Across regions, West India led retail growth at 6 per cent, followed by North and South India at 5 per cent each. East India reported a relatively subdued growth of 4 per cent, reflecting a more measured pace of consumer demand, RAI noted. Kumar Rajagopalan, CEO, RAI, said, "Growth eased to 5 per cent in May, down from 7 per cent in April, as inflationary pressures from global conflicts weighed on consumer sentiment. Retailers are watching the situation closely as spending turns more cautious."

AI-DRIVEN ANALYTICS The industry body said that retailers are witnessing "measured consumer spending patterns", with value-conscious purchasing behaviour influencing demand across categories. "Businesses are maintaining a strong focus on invent-

India's electric freight market enters next growth phase

GREEN FLEET. The shift is being driven as much by economics as by sustainability

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India's electric freight market may be approaching an inflection point. Electric commercial vehicle (eCV) registrations jumped 154 per cent year-on-year to an estimated 6,600 units in Q1 CY26, while Tata Motors has won orders for more than 3,400 eCVs spanning trucks, buses and small cargo vehicles. Equivalent to more than half of the industry's quarterly retail volume, the order pipeline suggests fleet operators are increasingly deploying EVs as business assets rather than pilot projects.

SHIFT IN APPLICATION For years, India's CV electrification story was largely confined to pilot programmes and limited deployments in urban delivery fleets. That dynamic now appears to be changing. Tata Motors' orders include about 2,000 small CVs and pick-ups, around 900 trucks and 500 buses. Freight applications account for the largest share, highlighting growing confidence in electric cargo mobility across vehicle categories. The shift is being driven as much by economics as sustainability. Fleet operators are increasingly evaluating



PICKING UP PACE. Electric truck demand is beginning to gather momentum as fleet operators explore electrification beyond urban routes **GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO**

EVs based on total cost of ownership, uptime and route suitability rather than environmental goals alone. Adoption is also expanding beyond last-mile delivery. Tata Motors said its orders span sectors such as logistics, FMCG and consumer durables distribution, cement, steel, mining and airport tarmac operations, indicating that electrification is beginning to penetrate a broader set of commercial use-cases.

GROWTH BROADENS Growth is no longer being driven by a single segment. While electric cargo three-wheelers continue to account for the bulk of volumes, the e-LCV segment is gaining traction among e-commerce, logistics and distribution companies seeking higher payload capacity and lower operating costs. Electric truck demand is

also beginning to gather momentum as fleet operators explore electrification beyond urban routes. The order pipeline suggests improving confidence in vehicle performance, charging availability and operating economics for heavier-duty freight applications. Much of the growth is being driven by corporate and institutional procurement rather than retail demand. Large fleet operators are increasingly selecting EVs based on operating economics, service support and vehicle uptime, creating opportunities for manufacturers that can offer integrated fleet solutions rather than standalone products. The market is also becoming more competitive. Alongside Tata Motors, players such as Euler Motors, Mahindra Last Mile Mobility, Switch Mobility, Omega Seiki Mobility and Montra

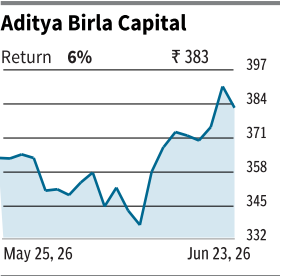
Electric are expanding their presence across cargo applications. "The strongest signal for the industry is that customers are no longer buying EVs for pilot projects—they are buying them for operations. Whether it is e-commerce, FMCG distribution, logistics or industrial freight, fleet operators are now evaluating EVs as business assets. That is a sign the market is entering a new phase of maturity," said Uday Narang, Founder and Chairman, Omega Seiki Mobility.

POLICY SUPPORT Policy support is beginning to reinforce the market's growth trajectory. Earlier this month, the Delhi government approved a vehicle replacement programme aimed at replacing older CVs operating in the NCR region with cleaner BS-VI and electric alternatives. Industry participants expect such initiatives to create an additional demand channel beyond conventional fleet purchases. For manufacturers, the challenge is no longer proving that electric freight vehicles can work. The next phase will depend on scaling charging infrastructure, service networks, financing models and fleet management systems quickly enough to support larger deployments.

Grasim Industries invests ₹2,880 crore to increase stake in Aditya Birla Capital

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Grasim Industries has increased its stake in Aditya Birla Capital marginally with an investment of ₹2,879 crore. The company has increased its stake to 52.30 per cent from 52.27 per cent by participating in the preferential issue on Tuesday, said Aditya Birla Capital in a regulatory filing. Grasim was allotted 8.09 crore equity shares of Aditya Birla Capital at a price of



₹356 per share, including a premium of ₹346 per share. Aditya Birla Capital operates as a non-banking financial company and recorded a consolidated turnover of ₹45,509 crore in FY26.

The company increased its stake to 52.30 per cent from 52.27 per cent by participating in the preferential issue on Tuesday

The company reported a consolidated turnover of ₹40,590 crore in FY25 and ₹33,941 crore in FY24.

OTHER ALLOTMENTS Aditya Birla Capital allotted

56.18 lakh equity shares to Suryaja Investments Pte Ltd, Singapore (an Aditya Birla Group entity and promoter group of the company), at ₹356 per share. The total investment was about ₹200 crore. International Finance Corporation also acquired about 2.58 crore equity shares at ₹356 apiece aggregating to investment of over ₹919 crore. Consequently, the paid-up equity share capital of Aditya Birla Capital will increase from ₹2,622 crore to ₹2,734 crore, it said.

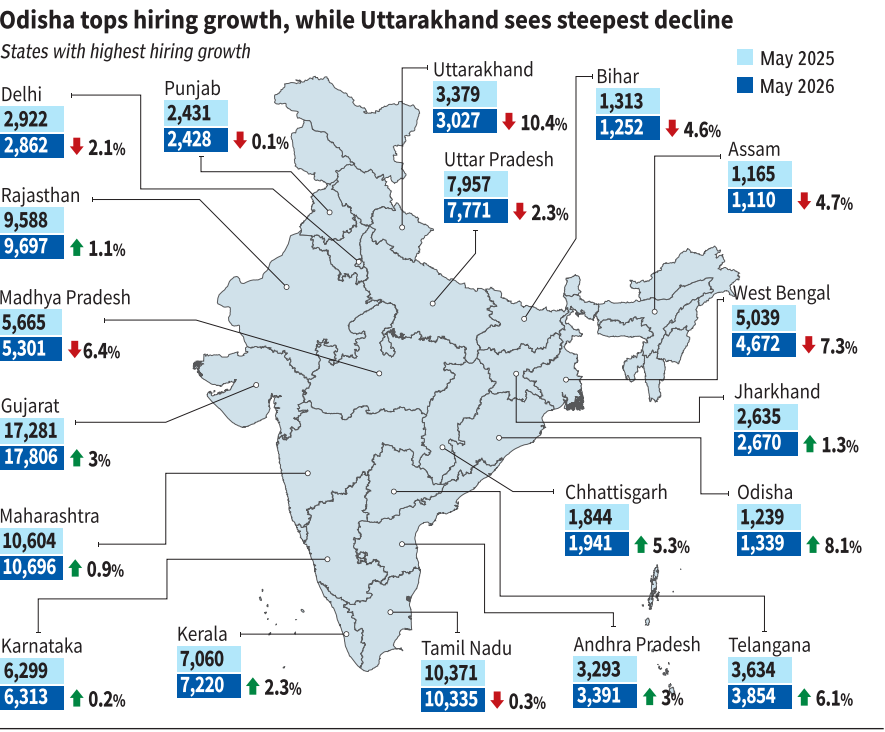
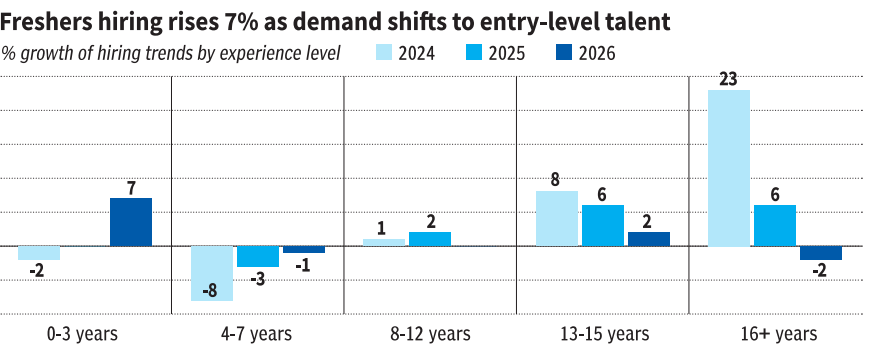
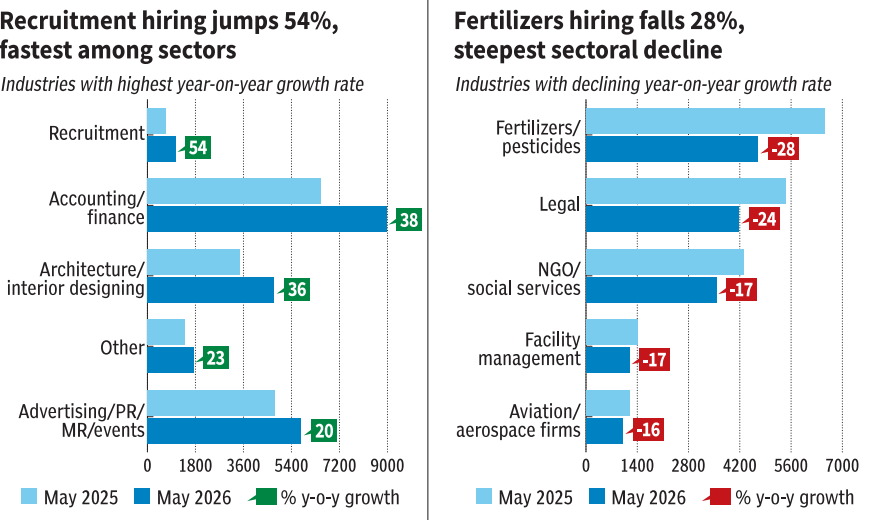
VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic KS Gunasekar

Freshers lead hiring growth

India's white-collar job market continued to expand in May 2026, though growth remained uneven across sectors, experience levels and regions. The latest Naukri JobSpeak report shows strong hiring momentum in sectors such as recruitment, insurance and BPO/ITeS, while freshers and non-metro cities emerged as key beneficiaries. The monthly report draws insights from over 1.5 lakh employers and more than 80 lakh job mandates annually

Key findings		
Insurance sector +19% y-o-y growth, led by Chennai (17%) and Ahmedabad (11%)	Healthcare sector +6% growth, driven by Indian MNC hiring	BPO/ITeS sector +9% growth, with fresher hiring up +29%
Seasoned professionals >16 years of experience) -2% hiring	Hyderabad hiring Overall hiring rose 6%, with GCC hiring up +20%	Non-metro fresher hiring Jaipur and Coimbatore grew +14% and +13% y-o-y



Source: Naukri JobSpeak Report

Newme aims to strengthen omnichannel play

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Fashion tech start-up Newme is targeting to double its retail footprint by the year-end, as it aims to strengthen its omni-channel play. The Gen-Z focused brand, which was founded in 2022, is backed by marquee investors including Accel India, Fireside Ventures and Point72 Ventures. As of May-end, Newme operates 25 stores in the country across 14 cities through the company-owned and company-operated retail model. It has also expanded into quick commerce through Newme Zip, currently operational in Delhi and Bengaluru. Sumit Jasoria, Co-founder and CEO, Newme, told *businessline* that the brand is looking to double the number of stores to 50 by December-end. "A strong retail footprint enables in strengthening consumer trust as they want to experience the brand. Our stores are not just conventional shopping destinations, but have evolved into immersive spaces for the Gen Z consumers," he added. Jasoria said that the brand is looking to open more stores in cities, where it already has a presence, such as Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru and Hyderabad. "We would like to have five stores per city across the top 20 cities. At the same time, we will look at expanding into new cities," he added.

Jamco Interiors plans \$150 million investment in India

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Jamco Interiors plans to invest \$150 million over the next three-four years in India. The company is set to open a new engineering facility in Bengaluru's Bannerghatta, while expanding its engineering and manufacturing capabilities in the country. "We opened another facility and have hired 20-30 people over the last two-three months. We plan to hire another couple of hundred people over the next few months," the company said. In an exclusive interaction with *businessline*, Kate Schaefer, CEO and Executive Chair of the Board, said India's aerospace engineering talent remains underutilised and is often viewed only as a low-cost engineering destination. "India has been seen as a place for low-cost engineering, as opposed to our experience that this is a place where you can hire some of the best talent. We can design in India as well," Schaefer said. "We can hand over the design responsibilities for some of these products to these engineers. Indian engineers want to design, not just work on packages," she said. "We're going to design in India. It's not just about offloading work to India."

Tata Electronics' data breach exposes new cyber reality

Our Bureau
Mumbai/Hyderabad

The cybersecurity breach suffered by Tata Electronics on Monday highlights the need for an avant-garde approach to safeguarding enterprise information, according to experts *businessline* spoke to. A Tata Electronics spokesperson confirmed the security breach after ransomware group World Leaks posted company details related to Apple and Tesla. "A few weeks ago, Tata Electronics identified a cybersecurity incident on some of our systems. Our response protocols were deployed im-

mediately, and the incident has had no impact on our operations across businesses, which remain unaffected," said the spokesperson. Reports indicate that the hackers were able to access purported component design and specification documents related to Apple and Tesla, both customers of Tata Electronics.

BLAST RADIUS Such supply chain breaches are among the most damaging in cybersecurity, considering the blast radius that reached beyond the breached entity, according to Srinivas L, Joint MD and Joint CEO, 63SATS Cyber-tech.



Kate Schaefer, CEO, Jamco Interiors, and Executive Chair of the Board

looking to diversify its supply chain beyond Japan. "Today, we assemble them and everything is purchased through our supply chain in Japan. Frankly, that supply chain doesn't have the capacity to keep up with our

growth. We expect to grow internally by about 2.5 times over the next three-four years." "As a result, the supply chain that is currently concentrated in Japan needs to be expanded to other parts of the world. I have long experience with India's supply chain and suppliers, which are excellent. Along with the design engineers, we're going to build our manufacturing engineering capability and have that team work with suppliers here in India." She added that alongside this expansion, the company's procurement from Indian suppliers is expected to increase significantly over the next few years.

SUPPLIER BASE Sanjeev Sen, Chief Operat-

ing Officer, Jameco Interiors, said the company's engineering footprint across Pune and Bengaluru will span about one lakh sq ft. "The team in Pune and Bengaluru will help us build a much wider supplier base. Initially, they will focus on two commodity groups, along with wire harnesses, before expanding to the remaining strategic commodities," Sen said. "I believe we will work with around 90 suppliers across Karnataka, Maharashtra and other regions. South India is particularly rich in terms of its supplier base," he said. "Over the next nine months, we hope to source about 30 per cent of our key commodities from India," Sen added.



With rising AI adoption, enterprises must embrace a new model of resilience

"When a manufacturer's network is compromised, the attacker inherits trust relationships, customer schematics and proprietary specifications belonging to clients. A single intrusion can expose multiple global corporations simultaneously, converting one

vendor's weakness into systemic risk across the ecosystem," he said. He also warned that the exfiltration of design and inspection documents exposes trade secrets, contractual confidentiality and downstream client liabilities all at once. For this reason, PrivaSapien argued that the future of cybersecurity must adopt a 'breach by default' mindset, particularly in the face of growing AI-generated attacks. The company noted that as data moves across increasingly interconnected ecosystems with rising AI adoption, enterprises must embrace a new model of resilience —

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Troubled finances

TN's fiscal white paper, a candid appraisal

The White Paper on the public finances of Tamil Nadu for the period between FY22 and FY26 released by the new TVK-led government paints a picture of total disregard for fiscal prudence by the previous DMK government. Heavy spending and leakages in revenue collections have led to a consistently elevated revenue deficit and ballooning debt in the last five years.



The White Paper indicates that salvaging the fiscal situation would require a sharp focus on increasing tax compliance, expanding the tax net by plugging corruption and reining in wasteful expenditure. It is remarkable that India's premier industrial State with a strong services presence should slip up in revenue collections. While Maharashtra and Karnataka have managed to bring revenue deficit below 1 per cent of GSDP in FY26 and Gujarat recorded a revenue surplus, Tamil Nadu has consistently recorded revenue deficit over 2 per cent of GSDP in the last five fiscal years. The post-Covid correction has clearly not happened. This is largely due to the State's total revenue receipts declining from 10 per cent of GSDP in FY22 to 8.32 per cent in FY26. Committed expenditure such as salaries, pensions and interest along with other statutory obligations account for almost 87 per cent of revenue receipts, leaving little room for productive investment. Capital expenditure as a percentage of GSDP has therefore been declining from 1.79 per cent in FY22 to 1.44 per cent in FY26. With the State borrowing to meet its annual expenditure, outstanding debt stock has doubled over the last five years to ₹10 lakh crore. The interest on these loans is resulting in crowding out other productive spending. The ratio of interest payments to capital expenditure in FY26 stood at 1.32:1 in FY26.

While the new government has done well to acknowledge the magnitude of the problem, it must now make an honest attempt to set things right. It can start by assessing the fiscal impact of its numerous poll promises, such as ₹2,500 per month grant for female heads of families along with six free LPG cylinders and eight grams of gold, silk saree for brides, gold ring for newborns, grants for unemployed youth, farm loan waivers and interest free higher education loans. It should drop those that are unproductive. There must be a conscious effort to reduce annual borrowing. Revenue reform holds the key. All heads of Tamil Nadu's own tax revenue including SGST, excise duty on fuel and excise and VAT on liquor have registered a decline as percentage of GSDP over the last five years.

The tax net must be expanded to include all companies in the manufacturing and services sector, including those under-reporting revenue. Leakage of tax revenue in liquor sales must be addressed too. While taxes on liquor in Tamil Nadu mopped up ₹11,836 crore in FY26, the collections in Maharashtra and Karnataka were several multiples higher. Stamp duty collections do not correspond with transaction value, pointing to corruption. Hopefully, the new government will read the writing on the wall and more importantly set a saner financial course for the State.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

EUROPE

The myth of Alan Greenspan as the 'Maestro'

Alan Greenspan, who died Monday at age 100, is being hailed in the press as a great central banker with the flaw that he didn't endorse enough financial regulation. That narrative obscures the real success and failure of the man who presided as Chairman of the Federal Reserve from 1987-2006. The paradox of Greenspan's career is that he presided over the best and worst modern eras of the Fed. Appointed by Ronald Reagan to replace the great Paul Volcker, Greenspan kept the Fed on the policy path of disinflation. This became known as the Great Moderation as inflation was largely contained while the US economy grew in robust fashion. (NEW YORK, JUNE 22)



Social media ban will set much-needed digital boundaries

Time flies, it is said. When it comes to those often-carefree years of childhood and early adolescence, young people's race towards adulthood can make time pass even more swiftly. Growing up in the early 21st century has become a fraught experience for many as the speed of technological change and the ubiquity of social media combine to distort the experience of childhood. For years, society has developed technology with few guardrails at breakneck speed. At a time when digital platforms have become deeply embedded in childhood and fears have grown about the well-being of minors online, the UAE is taking action to draw some much-needed boundaries. A UAE Cabinet resolution marks an important moment for child protection. (DUBAI, JUNE 23)

RBI's timely move on margin trade

BANKABLE. RBI's latest steps will reduce the chance of stress in the stock market spilling into the banking system



SUMIT SAURAV
SOUMIK BHUSAN
SOBHESH K AGARWALLA

In Indian equity markets, trading with borrowed money, or margin trading, has become easier than ever before. What was once mainly available to high-net-worth investors is now available to ordinary retail investors as well through discount or full-service brokers. This has led to a sharp rise in margin trading in India. NSE data show that total daily outstanding under margin trading rose sharply after 2020, reaching about ₹1.16 lakh crore by April 2026.

Margin trading has both benefits and risks for the investor. The benefit is, it allows investors to take a larger position than their capital would otherwise permit. If the market moves in their favour, this can increase their profits. But it also increases risk. If the market swings against them, losses also become larger which may wipe out the investors' capital. Investors in such situations also face margin calls, which force them to bring in more money or sell shares at a loss.

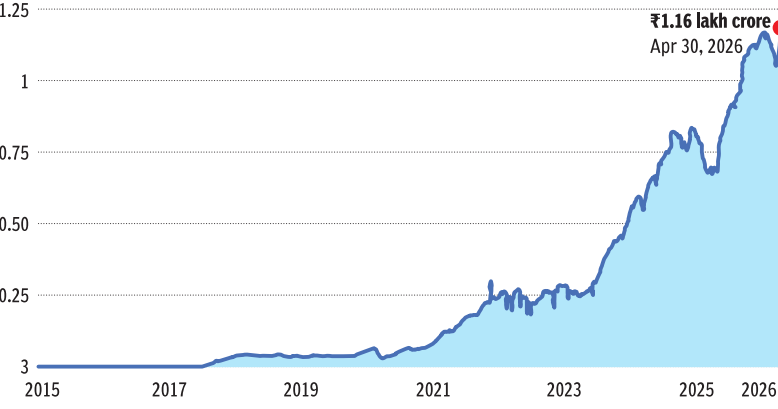
The same logic applies to the market as a whole. Margin trading can improve liquidity. By allowing investors to take larger positions, it increases buying and selling in the market. This can make it easier to trade without moving prices too much, lowering trading costs for investors. But it can also make the market more fragile i.e., increase systematic risk. Brokers keep collaterals in form of cash or share pledge for margin trading line given to the investor. When share prices fall, the value of these collateral falls. Brokers then ask investors to add more money or securities. If investors cannot meet these margin calls, brokers sell the shares bought on margin and/or liquidate the pledged shares. These forced sales add selling pressure, which pushes prices down further. That can trigger more margin calls and more forced sales — a self-fulfilling contagion. In this way, excessive margin trading can turn a normal market wide price correction into a sharper market fall.

KEY QUESTIONS

This is why regulators across the world

India's margin trading boom

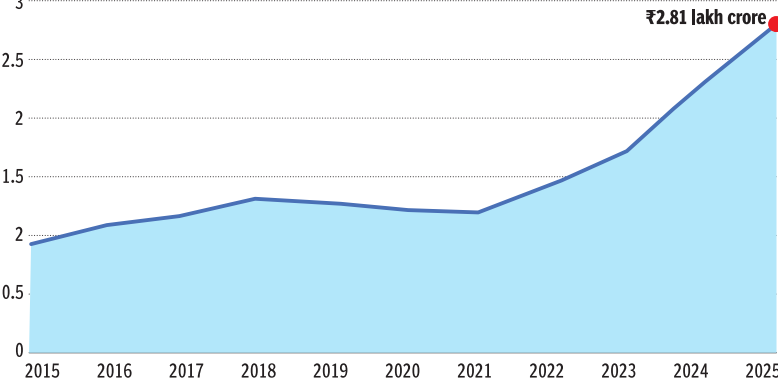
Daily exchange-reported closing outstanding, 2015-2026
Total daily outstanding in MTF (in ₹ lakh crore)



Source: NSE CM Marging Trading Disclosure

Bank lending to capital market sector

(in ₹ lakh crore)



Source: RBI Annual Report (lending to sensitive sectors)

track margin trading closely. Three questions matter most. First, how large is the margin book compared with the market? Second, how does it behave when market conditions change? Third, who is funding it?

The first question tells us whether the risk is small or system-wide. If margin borrowing is tiny compared with the overall market, forced selling may remain contained. But if it becomes large, a fall in prices can create wider

As the margin trading facility book grows, the system must make sure that leverage remains backed by real capital and strong collateral

stress. The second question is about timing. Margin trading often grows when markets are rising and investors feel confident. But the real test comes when markets fall or remain volatile. If the margin book shrinks slowly, the system may absorb the shock. But if the margin book remains high during a volatile phase, even a modest negative shock can trigger margin calls and forced selling, turning a normal market fall into a much sharper decline.

The third question is about where the money comes from. If margin trading is funded mainly by brokers using their own capital, the risk is concentrated in the broking system. If it is funded by bank credit, the risk can travel from the stock market into the banking system. That is why the source of funding matters as much as the size of the margin book.

India's position on these three fronts is mixed. On size, the margin trading book is relatively small compared to developed markets: total daily outstanding under margin trading facility (MTF) was about ₹1.16 lakh crore on April 30, 2026, roughly 0.25 per cent of India's market capitalisation. If we adjust for free-float market capitalisation, it becomes roughly 0.5 per cent. This is lower than in the US, where Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (FINRA) data show margin debt of about \$1.30 trillion in April 2026, or roughly 1.7-2 per cent of market value.

On timing, however, India deserves closer attention because the MTF book has risen sharply since 2022 and remains high in a more volatile market. That means a negative market-wide shock could be amplified through margin calls and forced selling. On funding, the key issue is bank exposure. RBI data show that bank lending to the capital market sector rose to ₹2.81 lakh crore in 2025 from ₹0.93 lakhs crore in 2015. This does not mean the system is unsafe, but it does mean regulators should track who is funding the leverage, not just how much leverage exists.

THE OTHER SIDE OF RISK

India has a margin trading boom, but it is not unregulated. The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) regulates the market side through eligibility rules, daily mark-to-market, margin calls, exposure limits, and volatility-linked margin requirements. The Reserve Bank of India's recent changes now address the other side of the risk, who funds the leverage. This is the right direction. By requiring bank loans to brokers and capital market intermediaries to be fully secured, applying stricter haircuts to equity collateral, limiting banks' capital-market exposure, and preventing banks from funding brokers' proprietary trading, the RBI reduces the chance that stress in the stock market spills into the banking system.

The lesson is simple. Margin trading should not be discouraged. It improves liquidity and gives investors more choice. But as the MTF book grows, the system must make sure that leverage remains backed by real capital and strong collateral. RBI's latest move is a timely step towards that balance.

The writers are faculty members at IIM Bangalore, TA Pai Management Institute, Bengaluru and IIM Ahmedabad, respectively

The infra challenge in Delhi's EV ambition

For its EV policy to click, land must be made available for public charging stations and residential units wired for the future

Abhishek Tripathi
Ashutosh Senger

The Delhi Government recently released its Draft Delhi Electric Vehicle (EV) Policy 2026. This draft comes on the back of the Delhi EV Policy 2020, which has been extended since August 2023, when it expired. The current draft is the third version of the policy since 2025, the earlier two versions did not reach the public domain. At first blush, the draft presents an ambitious statement of intent, by proposing aggressive phase-out mandates to ban new internal combustion engine (ICE) two-wheelers from April 2028, mandating only electric three-wheeler registrations from January 2027, and electrifying government fleets entirely. To nudge individual owners towards EV transition, the policy proposes a cascading set of purchase incentives for two-wheelers, three-wheelers and goods vehicles, alongside scrappage bonuses that extend to private car buyers as well. This intent is backed by a budgetary outlay of nearly ₹3,954 crore.

Behind the headline mandate lies a challenge that the policy largely sidesteps. Delhi does not yet have the infrastructure to charge the vehicles it is asking its residents to buy. Delhi currently has over 10,000 charging points, and EV charging load has surged nearly nine time, from 24 MW in 2018-19 to over 227 MW today. Some projections suggest that if Delhi were to

convert its entire vehicle fleet to EVs, the city's annual incremental electricity demand would approach 26,000-28,000 GWh. This will effectively amount to adding another Delhi to the grid in terms of electricity consumption. Modelling estimates suggest that on peak demand days, even under optimistic managed-charging scenarios, this transition would add between 1,500 and 5,000 MW of additional demand on a grid whose all-time peak has been 8,656 MW. Managing this surge in demand will need infrastructure augmentation.

NODAL AGENCY

In this context, the designation of Delhi Transco Ltd (DTL) as the nodal agency for planning and coordinating public EV charging and battery swapping infrastructure is perhaps the right move. It is beyond doubt that the current transmission and distribution infrastructure design cannot absorb the load that simultaneous charging of EVs will put on the system. To make EV transition a reality, thousands of transformers will need to be upgraded or replaced, new feeder lines will have to be set up, and existing lines will have to be reinforced. Whether that can be realistically achieved in the four-year window of this policy cycle remains anybody's guess. If it must be done, the policy is silent on how it proposes to achieve that, whether in terms of planning or funding.

A fair few interventions will be required at the policy level to achieve this. EV charging will have to be



EV CHARGING. The load must be staggered REUTERS

managed in a way that the charging load remains staggered through the day and does not disproportionately add to the peak demand. This will have to be done through dynamic time-of-use electricity pricing that incentivises charging during off-peak hours.

There is also the question of land, perhaps the most underestimated constraint in Delhi's EV infrastructure story. Public charging stations need physical space, and in one of the most densely built cities in the world, space does not come easily. To begin with, the draft policy does direct urban local bodies and other land-owning agencies to periodically identify suitable land parcels for deployment of public EV charging and battery swapping infrastructure. However, allocation of public space comes with its own challenges, of encroachment, building bye-laws, and constraints of local political economy. On top of that there is the issue of pricing. If public auction

of land becomes the default mode, the public will pay the price through high charging fee. The exercise must be truly done in a public-private partnership mode, where the land is either made available at nominal cost or the civic agencies are paid through revenue share rather than upfront payment.

Building bye-laws too will have to catch up. A significant share of Delhi's future EV charging will happen not at public stations but at homes, housing societies, and commercial premises. The bye-laws will have to mandate EV-ready electrical infrastructure not only in new construction, but also in the retrofitting of existing buildings. Commercial buildings, malls, multiplexes, and office complexes will also have to be brought under a similar mandatory EV-ready parking norm. For existing buildings, a simplified procedure for obtaining separate EV metered connections may have to be introduced through the two discoms.

For the policy to be effective, it needs to address the structural challenges in the power sector and urban infrastructure. Purchase incentives, registration bans, and scrappage bonuses, are the sweeteners, but the real nourishment will come when grid is ready, land is available where it is needed, and buildings are wired for the future. Until these foundations are in place, the policy mandate will only remain aspirational.

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LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Makhana in demand

This refers to 'Bihar's makhana potential' (June 23). The State produces more than 80 per cent of India's makhana and plays a dominant role in the global supply of this nutritious superfood. With growing global demand for healthy, gluten-free, and plant-based foods, makhana has gained popularity globally. Recent exports to Dubai and other international destinations indicate the expanding market opportunities for Bihar's farmers and entrepreneurs. However, challenges such as inadequate

processing facilities, poor packaging, limited branding, and lack of quality certification continue to restrict export growth. Better infrastructure, modern processing units, farmer training, and stronger government support can help Bihar capture a larger share of the global health-food market.

Bal Govind

Noida

Exit Starmer

Britain's political instability has become a worrying pattern. With Keir Starmer stepping down, the UK

is set to see its 7th PM in a decade, prematurely exiting the high office. Britain has been part of a club of countries called the European Union since 1973. However, Brexit in January 31, 2020, fractured both major parties and reshaped voter loyalties. Prime ministers have struggled to manage its economic and political consequences. From David Cameron to Starmer, each leader has faced the aftershocks. British voters now punish governments faster. The bigger question is whether this is merely a leadership crisis or a deeper

structural crisis in British democracy. Gregory Fernandes Mumbai

Coal exchanges

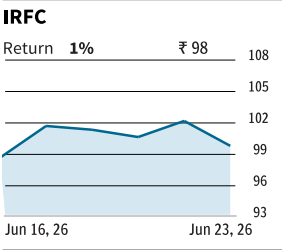
Apropos 'Value of coal' (June 23), the government's decision to establish coal exchanges is a sensible step towards market-based price discovery, but its success depends entirely on regulatory credibility. Coal India's dominance — controlling roughly three-fourths of national output — means that without genuine competition, exchanges risk becoming

instruments of price management rather than price discovery. The rules wisely restrict exchanges to physical delivery-based transactions for now, which is prudent. Independent coal sampling agencies and certified quality verification mechanisms are equally critical, since price transparency without quality standardisation is incomplete...If exchanges are to benefit both producers and consumers, the regulatory architecture must be impartial and consistently enforced. A Myilsami Coimbatore



QUICKLY.

Government to sell up to 2% in IRFC via OFS today



New Delhi: The government will sell up to 2 per cent stake in the Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC) through an offer for sale, starting Wednesday. In a post on X, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management Secretary Arunish Chawla said the government offers to disinvest 1 per cent equity in the IRFC along with an additional 1 per cent as a green shoe option. The floor price of ₹91 a share is at a discount of 7.79 per cent over Tuesday's closing price on BSE. Shares of IRFC closed at ₹98.69, down 2.16 per cent over the previous close on BSE. "Offer for Sale for Indian Railway Finance Corporation opens tomorrow for non-retail investors. Retail investors can bid on Thursday," the X post said.

ABSL AMC appoints Bhatia as head of passive funds

Mumbai: Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC has appointed Hemen Bhatia as Head - Passives, Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC. With over two decades of experience and a proven track record in building India's ETF ecosystem, his appointment marks a significant step in the company's ambition to strengthen its leadership in the rapidly growing passive investing space, the company said. Bhatia's announcement reinforces ABSLAMC's deep focus on accelerating growth in passive investing which has been witnessing significant momentum.

With Bengal govt supporting revival plan, Calcutta SE board to meet soon

GUNG-HO. Operations at Lyons Range can resume only after getting approval from market regulator SEBI

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

After the West Bengal government proposed to support the revival of the 118-year-old Calcutta Stock Exchange (CSE), a board meeting of the bourse is expected this month. In his Budget speech, Finance Minister Swapan Dasgupta, said the CSE, known as Lyons Range, is on the verge of closure due to several hurdles, and the State government proposed to support its revival to reclaim Kolkata's place as a financial capital. "It is a very welcoming decision taken by the West Bengal government. We all want to see that the CSE restarts its operation. We will

be holding a board meet this month to discuss the decision of the government. Following this, appropriate advice will be sent to SEBI," Deepankar Bose, Public Interest Director, CSE, told *businessline*. The CSE can resume its operation only after market regulator SEBI conveys its approval, Bose added.

TRADING HALT Trading at CSE was suspended by SEBI in April, 2013, following regulatory non-compliance. CSE members continued to trade directly on the National Stock Exchange platform through the local bourse. However, this service stopped in 2024. The CSE applied for a voluntary exit from stock ex-



MEGA PLAN. A file picture of the Calcutta SE in the BBD Bagh area of Kolkata. Will it rise from ashes like a phoenix? BLOOMBERG

change operations in February 2025 which is still pending with SEBI. CSE currently has net worth of over ₹100 crore, which is a regulatory requirement for a regional bourse. "The Calcutta Stock Exchange, an 118-year old insti-

tution is on the verge of closure due to several legal hurdles. My government proposes to support the revival of the Calcutta Stock Exchange so as to reclaim Kolkata's place as a financial capital. The revival of the CSE would have multifari-

Sumeet Industries to raise ₹200 crore via rights issue

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Sumeet Industries plans to raise ₹200 crore through a rights issue aimed at enhancing financial flexibility and supporting the company's strategic business priorities. The board of Sumeet Industries approved the terms of a rights issue aggregating to ₹200 crore through the issuance of ₹16.84 crore fully paid-up shares. The company is engaged in the production of pet chips, partially oriented yarn, fully drawn yarn and polyester textured yarn. The company proposes to deploy ₹49 crore from the rights issue pro-

ceeds towards the acquisition and operationalisation of an additional 140,000 tonne per annum polyester chips plant acquired from Nakoda in Surat, Gujarat. The project involves a total capital outlay of ₹90 crore with the balance ₹41 crore being funded through internal accruals. The project is expected to be recommissioned in Q1 FY28. Pratik R Jaju, MD, Sumeet Industries, said the proposed fund raise will support key strategic priorities, including working capital requirements, integration of acquired manufacturing assets, debt reduction and investment in a captive solar power facility.

SEBI proposes common advertising code for regulated entities

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Tuesday proposed a Common Advertisement Code (CAC) for specified regulated entities, seeking to replace multiple entity-specific advertising frameworks with a single set of rules aimed at reducing compliance burdens while strengthening investor protection. The proposed code will apply to stock brokers, depository participants, investment advisers, research analysts, online bond platform providers, portfolio managers and mutual funds/asset management companies. It will be incorporated into the

SEBI (Intermediaries) Regulations, 2008.

REPORTING SHIFT

The regulator has proposed to replace the existing requirement of prior approval for advertisements with a post-issuance reporting mechanism. Regulated entities would be required to report advertisements within 24 hours of publication instead of obtaining approvals beforehand. "In this digital era, regulated entities publish dozens of social media posts, educational reels, and promotional content pieces daily. Subjecting each item to prior approval is neither efficient nor effective," the regulator said, inviting public comments by July 14.



SEBI has also proposed allowing regulated entities to engage celebrities for brand or entity-level promotion, subject to prescribed conditions. Celebrity endorsements of specific products or services would not be permitted. The regulator said the proposed framework seeks to create a unified, technology-enabled advertising regime that balances ease of doing

Promoter co sells Vedanta shares worth ₹2,149 crore

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Twin Star Holdings, the Vedanta Group's promoter group company, has sold about 73 million shares in Vedanta Ltd for ₹2,149 crore in a block deal on Tuesday. The shares were sold at ₹292 a piece, according to the sources. The proceeds are expected to be used to reduce debt at parent company Vedanta Resources, sources said.

PROMOTER HOLDING

Following the sale, Twin Star will hold about 40 per cent of Vedanta Ltd, while overall promoter ownership remains around 56 per cent. The Vedanta Group recently demerged its business to list four new entities on the stock exchange. The newly listed businesses include Vedanta Aluminium Metal, Vedanta Iron and Steel, Vedanta Oil and

Gas and Vedanta Power. The promoters intend to reduce debt at the parent level by divesting stake, sources said. "With five listed entities and different capital structures, the group is now looking at accelerated deleveraging at the holding-company level. This deleveraging is coming ahead of schedule," one of the sources familiar with the matter said.

DEBT REDUCTION

The stake sale comes as the billionaire Anil Agarwal-led Vedanta Group seeks to simplify its balance sheet and reduce refinancing risk at VRL, which has long been closely watched by investors because of its debt obligations. Vedanta Resources has debt of \$5.25-\$5.5 billion and plans to extend the tenor of its loans through a mix of long-tenor bonds and amortisation of loans, said people aware of the matter.

Jio-BlackRock Broking moves IFSCA for broker-dealer, advisory licences

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Jio BlackRock Broking Pvt Ltd has applied to the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) for permission to operate as a broker-dealer and investment advisor from GIFT City's International Financial Services Centre (IFSC), as the Reliance-BlackRock venture expands its presence across financial services segments. The company has proposed to establish operations from GIFT SEZ in Gandhinagar and undertake activities permitted under the IFSCA (Capital Market Intermediaries) Regulations, 2025, subject to regulatory approvals from the unified regulator, official sources said adding that the application from the company was still being processed. The company plans to initially operate from a 17 square meter office space at Pragma Accelerator-II in GIFT SEZ and employ eight personnel. The proposed operations will be funded by its head office.



The move comes as GIFT City's broker-dealer ecosystem continues to expand, with more than 100 registered entities including SGX India Connect, Zerodha IFSC, Groww IFSC, Upstox Securities, Angel One, Motilal Oswal Finsec IFSC and Nuvama Capital Services IFSC, alongside offshore banking units of major lenders. The segment forms a key part of GIFT City's efforts to emerge as an international trading and investment hub. Under the IFSCA framework, broker-dealers form a key part of the capital markets ecosystem in GIFT City alongside investment advisers, investment bankers, custodians and other intermediaries. Broker-dealers can provide market access to in-

vestors and facilitate trading and investment activities within the IFSC framework.

EXPAND FOOTPRINT

The move builds on the group's existing presence in GIFT City. Jio BlackRock International AMC (IFSC) Pvt Ltd is already operating as a fund management entity (FME) in the IFSC, offering investment management services from the international financial centre. The proposed broking and advisory operations would expand the joint venture's footprint beyond asset management into capital market intermediation and wealth-related services. Jio BlackRock Broking is part of the broader 50:50 partnership between Jio Financial Services Ltd (JFSL) and BlackRock. Through the joint venture, the partners already offer asset management services in India via Jio BlackRock Asset Management Pvt Ltd and have outlined plans to expand into wealth management and broking through Jio BlackRock Investment Advisers Pvt Ltd and Jio BlackRock Broking Pvt Ltd, respectively.

Nexus Venture sells 43 lakh Delhivery shares for ₹208 cr

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

PE firm Nexus Venture Partners on Tuesday sold more than 43 lakh shares (0.57 per cent) of logistics company Delhivery for ₹208 crore through an open market transaction. The latest transaction marks the third stake sale by the US-based venture capital firm in Delhivery this year, following share sales worth ₹530 crore and ₹186 crore in April. According to BSE bulk deal data, Nexus Ventures III Ltd, an affiliate of Nexus Venture Partners, offloaded about 43.24 lakh shares at an average price of ₹481.

Turtlemint IPO sails through on last day

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The initial public offering (IPO) of Turtlemint Fintech Solutions received 1.2 times overall subscription on the final day of bidding, mainly on the back of institutional support. According to exchange data, the retail investors' portion was subscribed 1.07 times, while the qualified institutional buyers (QIB) category received bids for 1.59 times and the non-institutional investors (NII) segment remained under-subscribed at 0.52 times. Ahead of the public issue, Turtlemint Fintech Solutions raised ₹397.20 crore from anchor investors. The IPO came out with a price

Muted interest	
	No of times
QIBs	1.59
Non-institutions	0.52
Retail investors	1.07
Total	1.2

band of ₹144-152 a share. The IPO comprised a fresh issue aggregating up to ₹660.72 crore and an offer for sale of about ₹221.95 crore by existing shareholders and promoters. Turtlemint plans to utilise the net proceeds from the fresh issue to strengthen its cloud and server infrastructure, fund salary expenses for technology and product development teams, and support marketing and brand-building initiatives.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

STOVE KRAFT (BUY)

Target: ₹900
CMP: ₹748.90
Stove Kraft (SKL) is witnessing a transition in kitchen appliance demand dynamics amid multiple tailwinds. The West Asia conflict disrupted India's LPG supply chain, potentially triggering a structural shift in consumer behaviour toward induction cook-tops. The government is reinforcing this via several initiatives, which directly benefit established players like SKL. Beyond induction cook-tops, the broader kitchen appliances category is emerging from a post-Covid three-year demand slowdown, with discretionary spending starting to recover across channels (particularly GT). SKL is also witnessing a ramp-up in exports (FY26 was hit by tariff and war-related disruptions), led by the commencement of IKEA supplies and new product additions for Walmart. SKL's heavy capex cycle (FY22-26: ₹500 crore) is now behind. With 95 per cent of products manufactured in-house, it can achieve about 2x revenue (₹2,500 crore vs ₹1,500 crore in FY26) in two-three years from existing capacity with limited incremental capex. Hence, we believe incremental revenue growth should translate more meaningfully into profits than in recent years, with improvement in return ratios. Factoring in these positives, we build in FY26-28E revenue/EBITDA/EPS CAGR of 18 per cent/24 per cent/52 per cent, with 10.5 per cent/11 per cent/5 per cent FY27E/28E EBITDAM, and raise our TP by about 29 per cent to ₹900 (₹700 earlier) at 30x FY28E PER vs 11x FY28E EV/EBITDA earlier. Maintain Buy.

ICICI Securities

INDIAN HOTELS (BUY)

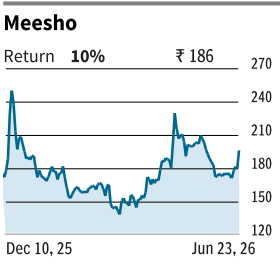
Target: ₹925
CMP: ₹724.10
FY26 saw Indian Hotels Company (IHCL) delivering resilient performance, with 16 per cent/15 per cent revenue/EBITDA growth against the backdrop of geopolitical disruptions in Q1FY26 and in March 2026. FY26 marked a record of 250 signings, expanding the company's portfolio to 630 hotel. Reflective of the rising affluence and accompanying demand, the company strengthened its presence in the luxury segment, with the: Onboarding of Claridges Collection acquisition of a controlling stake in Atmantan and acquisition of Brij Hospitality. Ginger acquired a majority stake in ANK Hotels and Pride Hospitality. The company opened/onboarded 130+ hotels, taking IHCL's operating hotels to 375 hotels. As of April 2026, IHCL has about 33,100 operational keys at an entity level, with a pipeline of another 31,300 keys set to open over the next four-five years. Apart from acquisitions, the company incurred capex of ₹1,040 crore in FY26, and with a strong net cash position of ₹4,300 crore as of March 2026, the company plans to incur ₹1,100-1,300 crore of capex in FY27 with additional room for growth through inorganic expansion. We believe the company's strong keys pipeline, coupled with high single-digit RevPAR growth at an industry level and contribution from new business and management fees, could enable mid-teens revenue/EBITDA growth in the medium term. Retain BUY with a revised TP of ₹925 (earlier ₹916), valuing the company on 30x Jun'28E EV/EBITDA.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Meesho (₹186.85): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook for Meesho has turned bullish. The stock has surged over 8 per cent on Tuesday and has closed on a strong note. This rise has happened after a strong base formation around ₹165 over the last three weeks. It also marks the end of the downtrend that has persisted since May. A cluster of supports is there in the ₹180-₹175 region. Below that, ₹170 is the next strong support. Meesho's share price can rise to ₹215 in the next few weeks. Traders can buy Meesho shares now at ₹186.85. Accumulate on dips at ₹178. Keep the stop-loss

at ₹168. Trail the stop-loss to ₹192 as soon as the stock reaches ₹196. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹198 and ₹205 when the price touches ₹203 and ₹209, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹212. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23810 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23700	23570	23880	24000	Go short now and at 23860. Keep the stop-loss at 23920

₹773 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
765	760	776	782	Go short now and at 775. Keep the stop-loss at 778

₹1029 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1015	998	1040	1070	Go short now and at 1035 with a stop-loss at 1045

₹290 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
289	286	291	293	Take fresh shorts below 289. Keep the stop-loss at 290

₹244 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
243	240	245	248	Stuck in a narrow range. Avoid trading this stock now

₹1306 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1300	1280	1325	1340	Take fresh shorts below 1300. Keep the stop-loss at 1305

₹1024 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1015	1000	1035	1050	Go short now and at 1030. Stop-loss can be kept at 1040

₹2060 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2050	2000	2085	2100	Go short on a break below 2050. Keep the stop-loss at 2060

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 278.80 pts.					
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WNN	
Axis Bank	1363.50	3.07	15.96	3.59	
PowerGrid Corp	291.95	2.18	17.05	1.21	
Cipla	1433.10	2.14	29.98	0.74	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1301.30	1.41	26.12	0.73	
Sun Pharma	1868.00	1.18	38.94	1.81	
Maruti Suzuki	13451.00	0.86	28.81	1.62	
Apollo Hosp	8487.50	0.42	60.94	0.80	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	993.35	0.15	23.31	1.28	
HDFC Life	597.45	0.07	67.41	0.59	
Kotak Bank	401.65	-0.80	20.71	2.71	
ONGC	244.35	-0.93	6.17	0.87	
Asian Paints	2661.20	-1.26	58.08	1.10	
TataConsumerProduct	1103.80	-1.29	70.62	0.66	
NestleIndia	1392.20	-1.52	76.72	0.91	
Eicher Motors	7578.00	-1.85	37.69	0.96	
SBI Life	1786.20	-1.89	72.52	0.74	
Bajaj Finserv	1765.00	-2.17	14.36	0.93	
Coal India	444.35	-2.31	8.81	0.92	
UltraTech Cement	11307.00	-2.46	40.69	1.23	
NTPC	364.60	-2.54	12.83	1.58	
Grasim Ind	3144.30	-2.57	20.77	1.10	
ITC	290.00	-2.63	17.29	2.56	
Tech Mahindra	1415.60	-2.72	28.86	0.82	
Trent Ltd.	3142.90	-2.74	97.36	0.96	
Max Healthcare	1078.05	-2.76	72.73	0.74	
IntGlobalAvi	4961.40	-2.95	0.00	1.03	
Tata Motors PV	354.55	-3.18	4352.25	0.68	
Bajaj Finance	962.40	-3.45	30.98	0.36	
Wipac	174.49	-3.55	12.80	0.46	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	2371.81	-3.99	36.79	0.71	
Bajaj Auto	10025.00	-4.02	26.50	1.02	
Hind Unilever	2160.10	-4.81	47.96	1.76	
HCL Tech	1109.50	-4.84	18.08	1.07	
M&M	3037.30	-5.09	20.28	2.49	
L&T	4179.40	-5.62	30.33	4.50	
Adani Enter	2962.30	-6.05	38.47	0.78	
Titan	4305.30	-6.06	75.33	1.63	
Adani Ports	1784.00	-6.96	32.16	1.21	
Eternal Ltd.	258.95	-7.39	682.78	1.71	
JSW Steel	1242.20	-8.23	11.91	1.07	
Hindalco	986.80	-8.66	16.56	1.31	
Bharti Elec	420.00	-8.99	50.64	1.38	
Tata Steel	139.65	-9.76	22.20	1.47	
Bharti Airtel	1901.60	-10.05	34.26	5.35	
State Bank	1024.20	-15.00	10.91	3.90	
TCS	2059.60	-15.21	15.07	1.93	
ICI Bank	1338.30	-22.01	16.54	8.77	
Reliance Ind	1309.50	-25.07	18.51	8.11	
Infosys	1028.30	-27.43	14.16	3.31	
HDFC Bank	774.65	-39.27	15.05	10.87	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 1,004.45 pts.
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WNN	
AvenueSuper	4392.90	26.91	96.25	2.63	
ZydusLifesciences	1112.20	19.60	21.84	1.13	
Torrent Pharma	4514.10	17.52	71.46	1.92	
Chadamed&Pharm	1725.90	8.92	28.10	3.01	
Britannia Ind	5241.00	8.12	49.76	2.51	
Shree Cement	25035.00	1.57	51.66	1.36	
Godrej Consumer	1020.70	1.42	56.11	1.67	
Bpcl	308.55	-0.30	5.18	2.55	
Bosch	40190.00	-2.80	42.74	1.42	
Tata Capital	352.45	-4.31	30.59	0.62	
United Spirits	1337.70	-4.68	52.11	1.61	
Pidlifind	1566.70	-5.00	64.54	1.98	
Hdfc Amc	2680.00	-5.92	40.17	2.22	
Vedanta Oil & Gas	33.29	-6.08	0.00	0.23	
Mazagon Dock	2506.70	-7.80	36.69	0.78	
HindustanAeronautics	4500.20	-8.35	33.02	3.48	
Hyundai Motor India	1968.90	-8.37	29.45	1.14	
Union Bank	175.12	-8.50	6.88	1.38	
Commins India	5735.50	-11.29	67.32	3.15	
Macrotech Developers	910.75	-13.13	26.52	1.04	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	195.67	-13.16	18.40	0.81	
Indian Oilcorp	143.17	-13.26	4.63	2.18	
Divis Lab	6747.00	-15.10	69.75	3.49	
Relaxo Industries	145.41	-15.29	94.87	3.97	
Abb India	7158.50	-15.31	96.00	3.15	
Ltimitrade	3768.40	-16.82	22.42	1.47	
Siemens Energy India	3793.60	-18.14	103.14	1.37	
Siemens	3685.90	-21.24	85.64	3.13	
Tvs Motor Corp	246.50	-22.39	51.53	3.30	
Indian Hotels Co	724.05	-23.06	45.86	2.59	
Amul Companies	44.85	-23.53	18.86	0.63	
Punjab Nat Bank	1074.3	-23.97	6.69	1.51	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	950.50	-24.25	125.09	2.65	
Gail (India)	173.84	-27.38	15.08	1.91	
Dif	612.35	-28.70	34.33	1.60	
Adani Power	231.19	-29.00	34.40	3.90	
Samarvirodhmineralsinternat	134.61	-29.08	37.10	1.93	
Rural Elec	361.90	-29.13	5.94	1.84	
Muthootfin	3119.60	-32.33	118.1	3.36	
Hindus Zinc	546.80	-33.58	16.70	0.96	
Varun Beverages	504.30	-34.73	53.14	2.81	
Bajaj Holdings	10615.00	-35.56	12.07	1.87	
Tata Power	998.30	-37.57	24.87	2.71	
Samarvirodhenergy	111.17	-38.06	37.10	2.96	
Power Finance	430.90	-42.93	4.23	2.55	
Canara Bank	130.37	-44.02	6.61	1.79	
Bank Of Baroda	227.80	-44.90	7.16	2.10	
Adani Energy Solutions	1493.70	-46.51	74.99	2.11	
Tata Motors Cv	400.05	-48.09	48.65	3.40	
Jindal Steel	1082.60	-53.67	32.86	1.63	
Pedana	281.70	-120.39	6.95	1.95	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

SBI Caps chosen as consultant for Hyd Metro



Hyderabad: SBI Caps has been selected as consultant to conduct a comprehensive study on the valuation of Metro Rail Phase-I, expansion of Phase-II, and other related matters. This was decided at a meeting of Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy, Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw and Union Coal Minister G Kishan Reddy in New Delhi on Tuesday. **OUR BUREAU**

Two dead in blaze at Dakshin Energy's plant

Hyderabad: A fire accident at Dakshin Energy factory in Pharma City, Parawada, Visakhapatnam, left two dead and two injured. According to the police, the fire broke out in the early hours of Tuesday. Fire tenders rushed to douse the flames and the injured were shifted to hospital. Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu expressed shock and grief over the mishap and directed officials to extend all help to the victims and their families. An investigation is on. **OUR BUREAU**

Andhra Pradesh clears ₹34,000 cr investments

Hyderabad: The Andhra Pradesh Cabinet has approved investments of ₹34,000 crore across sectors, which were previously approved by the State Investment Promotion Board (SIPB). The approved investments in clean energy, manufacturing, tourism and infrastructure, among others, are expected to generate about 35,000 jobs. **OUR BUREAU**

Ashok Leyland Foundation aims to educate 1m students by 2029, raises CSR spend to ₹60 crore

Our Bureau
Chennai

Ashok Leyland Foundation, the corporate social responsibility (CSR) arm of auto major Ashok Leyland Ltd, plans to expand its education initiatives to reach nearly one million students across India by 2029, while increasing its annual CSR expenditure to ₹60 crore from ₹40 crore. Speaking to reporters, Foundation Director NV Balachander said the organisation would scale up its flagship programmes — Road to School (RTS) and Road to Livelihood (RTL) — to other States, including Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh, with the aim of ensuring that every child has access to quality education. At present, the two programmes operate in 25 districts across nine States, benefiting around 6.3 lakh

‘To achieve Viksit Bharat goal by 2047, India must grow at 7-8%’

CLEAR PATH. Resurgence in private investment, strong expansion in exports are crucial: EAC-PM Chairman

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India must maintain an annual economic growth rate of around 7-8 per cent to realise the vision of ‘Viksit Bharat’ by 2047, according to S Mahendra Dev, Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM).

He said achieving this objective will largely depend on a resurgence in private investment and strong expansion in exports. He added that agriculture sector has an important role to play in achieving it.

The farm sector needs to be more diversified, nutritious, sustainable and climate resilient, he said while addressing industry body



EAC-PM Chairman S Mahendra Dev **V RAJU**

FICCI’s ‘India Innovative Crop Nutrition Conclave 2026’ in New Delhi.

On the sidelines, Dev said structural reforms implemented over the last few years had laid the groundwork for ‘Viksit Bharat’.

“We need investment for that. So, private sector investment is equally important, and export growth is

also important. The Prime Minister has mentioned Atmanirbhar Bharat. That is equally important,” Dev said.

He laid emphasis on the importance of enhancing India’s competitiveness and product quality to meet global standards.

The policy framework does not signal a retreat from global trade, instead

the focus remains on building domestic capability to leverage the country’s current demographic and technological advantages, he said.

The government had identified specific areas to reduce import dependencies, compiling a list of 100 items where domestic manufacturing can substitute foreign goods, he added.

RBI PROJECTION

“Overall, because of the West Asia war and also a bit of El Nino, I agree with the RBI projection of 6.6 per cent growth and also 5.1 per cent inflation,” Dev said.

Asserting the need to reduce consumption of chemical fertilizers through crop diversification, promotion of natural farming and offering

incentives linked to productivity gains, he said there is a need to improve crop productivity.

Pointing out that the West-Asia conflict has created supply problems and increased subsidy, he said global urea prices, fortunately, had come down sharply — from over \$900 to \$450 a tonne.

Stating that India had imported over 10 million tonnes of urea in the 2025-26 fiscal, he said sources of imports were getting diversified; there was also a focus on raising domestic production.

“As a next step we should consider a national nutrient use efficiency initiative that shifts our focus from the quantity of fertilizer consumed to the productivity it generates,” he said.

New FCRA Rules enforce stricter regulations on NGOs

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Centre has notified the amended Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Rules, 2026, introducing more compliances to restrict the engagement of foreigners, except of Indian origin, in key positions, accepting funds only for defined declared purposes and utilising them in the geographic location in which the organisation is registered.

Other than that, the modified rules bar seeking or using funds for religious education but allow a list of outlined faith-related activities at the time of registration, including construction, renovation and maintenance of places of worship such as

temples, mosques, churches, gurudwaras, monasteries, synagogues and other religious sites.

Three purposes — religious education, documentation of faith traditions and preservation of indigenous beliefs — must be carried out “excluding proselytisation” allowed under the Act earlier, stated the notification.

PRIOR PERMISSION

The definition of chief functionary has been expanded to include all trustees, governing council members and other senior management, and the amended Rule says that foreigners will “ordinarily not be considered” for the grant of registration or prior permission to receive foreign funds under the Foreign

Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA).

It, however, said that the government will have to come up with a separate order to specify cases or circumstance in which foreign nationals can be accommodated as key functionaries for an association for registration under the FCRA.

The wide-ranging amendments seek to bring in more accountability and transparency from the NGOs and associations for accepting funds from abroad.

“Every application for registration shall mention the purpose or purposes for which registration is sought, chosen only from such list of purposes as specified in the Schedule appended to these rules; and the States or Union Territories in which

the association proposes to undertake the activities,” the notification said.

The details shall be specified on the certificate issued to the NGO, it added.

The schedule also covers cultural, economic, educational and social categories as purposes for accepting donations from outside the country.

FOREIGN FUNDING

The compliance overhaul also demands that NGOs receiving foreign funding must now declare all social media accounts, websites and publications when applying for registration or renewal under the FCRA.

Existing associations registered before 2026 have been granted a one-year window to submit updated de-

tails, specifically declaring their exact operational purposes and geographic areas to the government.

FEE STRUCTURE

The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), which is the controlling Ministry, has introduced a tiered fee structure under the amended rules, levying an additional ₹300 for each subsequent State or objective added to an application.

To weed out inactive organisations, the government has instituted a minimum spending threshold. To qualify for registration renewal or to prevent cancellation, an NGO must have spent at least ₹10 lakh of its foreign contributions on its declared activities over the preceding two financial years.

India welcomes US-Iran peace MoU, says Hormuz opening will boost energy supplies

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India on Tuesday welcomed the US-Iran memorandum of understanding (MoU) on ending hostilities in West Asia, with National Security Advisor Ajit Doval saying it will stabilise global energy security and remove supply chain bottlenecks for key commodities and fertilizers.

The opening of the Strait of Hormuz is a welcome move for global energy security, Doval said, addressing a meeting of NSAs of BRICS nations — Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, Russian NSA Sergei Shoigu, Deputy Secretary of Iran’s Supreme National Security Council Ghadiri Nezamipour, and other top BRICS security officials attended the meeting chaired by Doval.

In his televised opening remarks at the BRICS NSAs



Ajit Doval speaking at the meeting in New Delhi **ANI**

meeting, Doval, touching upon the impact of “geopolitical uncertainties and economic strains”, underlined the need for the grouping to play a significant role in addressing the challenges.

“India welcomes the MoU reached between the US and Iran. We have got cautious optimism, and we hope that it will work. It will help energy security,” Doval said.

“The opening of the Strait of Hormuz is a very welcome development. It will remove

Public procurement list of medical devices under review

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Medical device makers are putting together their lists of products that are produced in the country, and those that are not locally manufactured, as part of the Centre’s review of a list that guides public procurement of medical devices.

The Department of Pharmaceuticals has received stakeholder suggestions to add or delete products from the global tender enquiry (GTE) exemption list of medical devices, it said, on the process that kicked off earlier in February. The industry has till July 15 to send in suggestions.

The domestic industry, though, is divided, with some calling for exemptions to “advanced technologies” not made locally, while others urge the government to outline a basket of products and encourage local manufacturers to make them.

The current GTE exemption list of 354 medical devices, notified in 2024 and valid until March 2027, was developed through a rigorous and consultative process involving all relevant stakeholders, said the Medical Technology Association of India (MTAI).

GTE EXEMPTIONS

“The guiding principle behind GTE exemptions has been to ensure patient access to medical technologies that are not yet adequately manufactured in India. Many MTAI members manufacture in India and strongly support the growth of domestic manufacturing,” said Pavan Choudary, Chairman MTAI.

“While the 2024 exercise was largely comprehensive, a few advanced technologies that are not manufactured in



India were missed out in the exemption list,” he said. “Any exclusion of technologies that are not adequately available in India risks limiting patient access to critical medical innovations and could adversely affect healthcare outcomes.”

MARKET ASSURANCE

The Association of Indian Manufacturers of Medical Devices (AIMED) are also in the process of mapping local manufacturing capabilities and capacities to ensure that products made in India are removed from the exemption list.

“For products where Indian manufacturers have already taken test licences, committed capital expenditure, or launched production but are yet to complete the three-year market standing requirement, there must be a mechanism to earmark a share of public procurement,” said Rajiv Nath, AIMED Forum Coordinator.

Stressing the need for domestic manufacturing, he said, medical device imports continue to rise — posting a 17 per cent increase to ₹89,000 crore last financial year, compared to ₹76,000 crore in the previous year.

Developing high-technology medical equipment is inherently challenging, he said, and the approval for Class C and D devices take 9-15 months.

Broadband Forum of India urges government to include GMPCS in latest satcom spectrum rules

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Broadband Forum India (BFI) on Tuesday requested the government to include Global Mobile Personal Communication by Satellite (GMPCS) in the latest draft Telecommunications (Spectrum Assignment by Administrative Process) Rules, 2026, by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).

In a letter to the Secretary, DoT, it also requested for mapping GMPCS to the appropriate Annexure(s) in Schedule I for the purposes of spectrum assignment, applicable terms and conditions, and determination of spectrum charges.

According to a gazette notification last week, satellite

companies will get spectrum administratively, unlike through auction for other telecom spectrum, and the process is fixed with an annual fee of ₹30,000 to ₹50 lakh, based on the service type, and there is a non-refundable application fee of ₹1,000.

DRAFT RULES

BFI said Section 3(2) of the draft rules provides that the entities specified in Schedule I of the draft rules shall be eligible for assignment of spectrum through the administrative process. “However, a comparison of Schedule I of the draft rules with Entry 16 of the First Schedule to the Telecommunications Act, 2023, indicates that GMPCS, which is expressly included in the parent Act, has not been corres-



KEY SHIFT. Satellite firms will get spectrum administratively unlike through auction for other telecom spectrum

pondingly reflected in the draft rules, though all other satellite-based services — commercial and non-commercial — have been included,” it pointed out in the letter.

BFI argued that the First Schedule to the Telecommunications Act, 2023, specifically identifies GMPCS as one

of the satellite-based services for which spectrum assignment is to be undertaken through the administrative route.

The inclusion of GMPCS in the Act is explicit and unambiguous, placing it alongside other satellite services covered under Entry 16, it added.

Right-of-way delays qualify as *force majeure*: Power regulator

M Ramesh
Chennai

In an important ruling, the Gujarat Electricity Regulatory Commission (GERC) has held that project delays arising from right-of-way (RoW) issues can, in certain circumstances, qualify as *force majeure*, that is events beyond the reasonable control of a project developer.

The implication is that a developer may be granted an extension of project timelines without attracting delay penalties.

Hearing a dispute between renewable energy developer Juniper Green and the State-owned power utility Gujarat Urja Vikas Nigam Ltd over delays in the commissioning of a 50 MW wind project, GERC accepted Juniper’s plea for relief, though for

fewer days than the company had sought.

Juniper had claimed *force majeure* protection on eight grounds, including RoW-related difficulties. The Commission rejected the other seven claims.

DISPUTE ESCALATION

The renewable energy industry, particularly the wind sector, has long complained that RoW issues have evolved beyond demands for fair compensation by landowners, mostly farmers, to what developers describe as extortion backed by local power brokers.

Such disputes frequently escalate into law-and-order problems. The Juniper case illustrates the challenge. The situation became serious enough for the company to seek police protection. The

Commission stressed that not every local objection would constitute *force majeure*. “However, where access to the project site is obstructed due to local resistance and the developer is compelled to seek police protection, the matter assumes a different character,” GERC said.

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**FIFA'26 doubles
Zee OTT audience**



Mumbai: Zee Entertainment's streaming platform Z5's users doubled in just two weeks since the start of the FIFA World Cup 2026, bringing the total weekly active users to 27 million, as per a CLSA report. "Zee's surge in Z5 and viewership will help capture revenues to also offset rights costs estimated at under \$60 million for eight years, adding upside to our growth forecasts," said the CLSA research note, noting a strong start to the World Cup with more than 100 million viewers over the opening weekend, across its digital, linear and social platforms. This includes hosting millions of concurrent users over the same weekend, with a notable increase in platform engagement as users consumed the live action, highlights and studio programming. Despite placing the World Cup as premium content, with a separate subscription package, Z5 has also become the most download OTT in the past two weeks. **OUR BUREAU**

Akasa Air eyes 30% capacity growth in FY27, on track for IPO in 2-3 years

ROSY OUTLOOK. Airline on 'certain and deterministic' path to profitability driven by fleet inductions, says CFO

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

After sustaining operational profitability for six consecutive months, Akasa Air (SNV Aviation) is targeting over 30 per cent capacity growth in FY27 while remaining on track for an initial public offering (IPO) in the next two to four years despite geopolitical tensions and fuel price volatility continuing to weigh on the aviation sector, its Chief Financial Officer Ankur Goel said.

Speaking in Delhi on Tuesday on the airline's financial performance and growth outlook, Goel said Akasa was EBITDA-positive for six straight months from September to March and remained on a "certain and deterministic" path to profitability, driven by continued fleet inductions and expansion of its domestic and international operations.

This trajectory, said Goel, is backed by continued aircraft inductions and expansion of its domestic and in-



Akasa's international operations could rise to nearly 40 per cent over the next few years

ANKUR GOEL
CFO, Akasa Air



ternational network.

Notably, the airline ended FY26 with a fleet of 37 aircraft, up from 27 aircraft a year earlier, after adding 10 Boeing 737 MAX aircraft during the year.

All additions, Goel pointed out, were brand-new aircraft and not leased or second-hand planes.

Meanwhile, Akasa's capacity, measured in available seat kilometres (ASKs), grew by around 30 per cent year-on-year in FY26 and is expected to increase by more than 30 per cent again in FY27.

The airline, Goel said, expects to continue expanding at a compounded annual growth rate of 30-40 per cent

revenues (RASK) improved by about 10 per cent on an adjusted basis despite rapid capacity additions, while its total unit cost, or cost per available seat kilometre (CASK), declined by 4 per cent year-on-year.

Excluding fuel, unit costs remained broadly stable despite currency depreciation and other external pressures, he said.

As a result, Akasa's EBITDA margins improved by a staggering 60 per cent during the year, bringing the airline closer to full-year operational profitability.

Goel noted that the unprecedented spike in aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices earlier this year had posed a significant challenge for airlines. However, government measures, including capping fuel price increases and reducing charges at certain airports, had helped maintain the viability of airline operations.

CAPACITY DEPLOYMENT
On capacity deployment, Goel said Akasa's interna-

tional operations now account for around 25 per cent of its total capacity and could rise to nearly 40 per cent over the next few years.

Additionally, the airline plans to deepen its presence in Southeast Asia, with Hanoi set to become its latest international destination in September.

The carrier currently operates a fleet of 39 aircraft and plans to have 226 aircraft by 2032.

In addition, Goel said Akasa had no plans to alter its business model by introducing premium cabins or leasing older aircraft, and it remained committed to operating a single-class, all-economy fleet.

On a potential IPO, he reiterated the airline's earlier timeline of two to four years.

Despite short-term headwinds, Goel said Akasa's long-term growth plans remained intact, with the airline continuing to hire pilots, cabin crew and engineers while taking deliveries of new aircraft and expanding its network.

Connectivity boost for Gujarat as Star Air starts Mundra flights

Aneesh Phadnis
Mundra



An Embraer E175 aircraft from Goa touched down at the Mundra airport on Tuesday, marking the launch of scheduled passenger services. The launch of Star Air services follows the development of a passenger terminal to boost air connectivity in the Kutch region of Gujarat.

While Bhuj and Kandla airports in Kutch handle regular passenger flights, traffic at Mundra has been limited to non scheduled operations. These include business jets and an air taxi service from Ahmedabad, operated by three-seater Tecnam aircraft.

From Tuesday, Mundra is being linked to Mumbai, Hindon and Surat in addition to Goa by Star Air. "We will be gradually adding flights here. We need our own connectivity as partners and employees frequently visit the city. There will also be tourism travel, which will add to demand," said Jeet Adani, Director, Adani Airport Holdings Ltd.

Adani described the

launch of direct connectivity to Mumbai as a "major breakthrough" for Mundra and said improved links with metro cities would provide a significant boost to the region's economic development.

HUGE POTENTIAL
Star Air Chief Executive Officer Simran Singh Tiwana doesn't see Mundra airport cannibalising traffic from Bhuj. While Bhuj is connected with Delhi, Star Air is flying to Hindon. "We are also connecting Mundra with Goa. I think Mundra has a huge potential," he added.

According to local MLA Aniruddha Dave, the Mundra airport will also benefit residents who are settled in West Asia and the UK.

Bhuj airport handled 2.8 lakh passengers last fiscal. Though it is an established market, it has limitations as it is controlled by the IAF.

Data centres resort to a shift in cooling strategy amid water crisis

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

With water woes looming on the horizon, Reliance's Jio Platforms has come up with an innovative method of using seawater for cooling its data centres and addressing sustainability concerns in India.

The urgency is evident. Data centres consumed around 150 billion litres of water in 2025, a figure set to more than double by 2030. A single 100 MW facility using conventional cooling can

draw roughly two million litres a day, most of it evaporated rather than returned, according to Greyhound Research.

SUSTAINABLE EFFORTS
Jio plans to power its latest 168 MW data centre at Jamnagar in Gujarat using easily available seawater rather than freshwater, the latest pivot towards sustainable efforts in the data ecosystem.

"The data centre will be powered by renewable energy and cooled with desalinated seawater, demonstrating both RIL's and Meta's

commitment to sustainability," said Jio in its announcement.

Praising the move, Greyhound Research, in its research note, said, "The use of desalinated seawater is far more sensible than drawing heavily on stressed municipal freshwater systems. However, it requires energy, intake systems, creates brine and discharge questions that demand local ecological governance. It must be measured, reported and audited rather than wrapped in a green ribbon and waved through."

While the latest development in the sustainability topic, the scrutiny towards cooling methods is not restricted to Jio.

For example, Yotta Data Services data centres focus primarily on air-cooling with tens of chillers installed on the terrace and closed-loop water-pipes running along every data centre floor to regulate the system.

"Once in six months, we have to top-up the closed water but even that is minimal," said Sunil Gupta, Founder of Yotta Data Services.

ESDS, too, plans to transition



Indian data centres away from purely water-based cooling towards other methods.

Particularly for its Mumbai facility, ESDS is using a "fully closed-loop water-cooled system" that continu-

ously recirculates the same water. "Fresh-water draw is limited to minor make-up — about 2,500 to 3,000 litres a year for the entire facility. Being a sealed, near-zero-loss loop, it avoids the heavy evaporative losses of open cooling towers, keeping our annual consumption a tiny fraction of a comparable conventional facility," said Ashok Pomnar, Senior Vice-President, ESDS.

This technique helps the plant at its most efficient point while sustaining a 1.5 power usage effectiveness.

Aside from these local

players, international players like Amazon Web Services (AWS) told *businessline* about their plans to invest more than ₹42 crore (\$4.3 million) in water replenishment efforts across India to restore over 3 billion litres of water annually.

"We also don't use water when cooling our data centres," said Sandeep Dutta, President, AWS India and South Asia.

MAJOR CONCERN
Despite the efforts announced by big players, water usage is a major concern

in India. With cities already facing water problems, credit rating companies like Moody's Ratings have flagged that India has a fragmented water governance structure, highly subsidised pricing and slow reallocation among sectors.

In such a backdrop, the rapid growth of the data centre ecosystem, driven by the expansion of cloud computing and AI, will add further water-intensive industrial pressure that governments and utilities will increasingly need to accommodate.



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5:10 pm - 5:30 pm



Dr. Sharanaprakash Rudrappa Patil
Minister for Medical Education and Skill Development of Karnataka

Keynote Speaker

5:30 pm - 5:40 pm



B V Naidu
Chairman, Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM)

Session 1 (5:45 pm - 6:30 pm):

ESDM- From Vendors to Value Creators



Ashok Chandak
President, IESA



Sachin Dhruva Naik
Founder & CEO, Cuzor Labs



B S Srinivasan
Managing Partner, Viprom Electronics



Sonam Motwani
Founder & CEO, Karkhana.io



Venkatesha Babu
Moderator, Resident Editor, The Hindu businessline

Fireside Chat

6:30 pm - 7:00 pm



Satish Kumar T
Chairman & Managing Director, Milky Mist Dairy Food

In conversation with

Raghuvir Srinivasan
Editor, The Hindu businessline

Session 2 (7:00 PM - 7:45 PM):

Talent skilling and labour challenges



Rakesh Patil
Co-Founder & CTO, Beyond Appliances



Kartik Narayan
CEO, Apna Co



Nitin Dave
CEO, Staffing Solutions, Quess Corp



Nagaraju S
Council Member, Panel Chairman, Labour Law, KASSIA, Synergy Punching (Promoter and Director)



Bharat Kumar
Moderator, Digital Editor, The Hindu businessline

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